

Empirical Project

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The effects of Instagram user identity, problematic Instagram use, desire thinking and trait anxiety on personal and collective self-esteem

Abstract

Objectives: To investigate the complex connection between social media and other associated factors and their detrimental effect on individuals well-being, in particular self-esteem. It is hypothesised higher levels of problematic Instagram use, social identification as an Instagram user, trait anxiety and desire thinking related to Instagram will predict lower levels of personal and collective self-esteem.

Methods: Two hundred Instagram users filled up the online survey consisting of 6 questionnaires. The obtained data was analyzed through hierarchical multiple regression analyses.

Results: Trait anxiety emerged as the only significant negative predictor of personal self-esteem and some aspects of collective self-esteem. Posting on Instagram and social identity as an Instagram user were significant positive predictors of importance of identity in collective self-esteem.

Conclusions: Anxiety is known to have a strong bi-variate relationship with self-esteem, however centrality of one's identity and activity on Instagram can be key in understanding motivations to use social media excessively and its consequences on self-esteem and mental health in general.

Instagram stands out as one of the premier social media platforms globally, with usage reaching previously unheard-of heights. This surge in utilization has sparked concerns regarding potential problematic patterns of engagement and their impact on psychological well-being. Instagram's design, aimed at maximizing user engagement, has led to behaviors resembling addiction, including cravings and preoccupation with the platform. Previous

research has mostly emphasized Facebook, and its detrimental effects on well-being, however it has failed to address those related to Instagram, as its use is wider across younger generations. This study explores how factors such as Instagram identity, problematic usage, desire thinking related to Instagram, and trait anxiety impact personal and collective self-esteem – a relatively underexplored area. Through multiple regression analyses on data obtained from 200 Instagram users, the study found that some aspects of Instagram identity and frequency of posting predicted collective self-esteem. Trait anxiety predicted personal self-esteem and some aspects of collective self-esteem. The need for more studies in this area is emphasized to fully understand the complex link between Instagram use and self-esteem in our highly digitalized era.

Introduction

With more than 2 billion users worldwide, Instagram is one of the most highly used social networking sites (Statista, 2024). In the UK, the platform has amassed a user base of 35 million as of February 2024. This growth trajectory with 127% increase in monthly active users observed over a span of four years from 2019 represents a sociocultural change especially for young adults aged 18–24 and 25–34, which are the primary users of Instagram (Statista, 2024; Stapleton et al., 2017).

Social networking sites like Instagram ensure instant connection to various social circles and medium of self-expression and identity exploration in addition to communication (Jun, 2022). Users are motivated by feelings of belonging, acceptance and a need for connection, while engaging in posting images, particularly selfies, and videos (Sheldon et al., 2011). This is what distinguishes Instagram among other social networking sites (SNS) as a platform preferred for personal expression and social interaction (Huang & Su, 2018). However, the

rise in Instagram popularity, its accessibility and usage have raised concerns regarding potential adverse effects on psychological health and self-esteem, as an important aspect of it (Pantic, 2014).

Most research has been focusing to Facebook as the biggest social platform so far, however Instagram has been growing rapidly and its largest user base is different in terms of age (18–24), which makes it even more vulnerable (de Vries & Kühne, 2015). Self-esteem has been linked to problematic internet use as well as personality, anxiety and eating disorders (O'Brien et al., 2006). Anything that impedes the development of positive self-esteem may prove harmful because self-esteem influences behavior in relation to different facets of daily life (Matthews & Odom, 1989). In this light, it is necessary to identify potential explanatory variables for the prediction of both individual and group self-esteem. The present study aims to investigate the relationship between social identity as a social media user, problematic social media usage, desire thinking related to social media, and trait anxiety regarding individual and group self-esteem. This study attempts to determine whether these predictors, in addition to other characteristics usually linked to problematic social media use, like posting, frequency, duration, and associated actions, have a relationship with self-esteem levels.

Social identity and self-esteem

Tajfel and Turner (1979) proposed that people have an innate desire for social belonging, deriving significant portions of their self-worth and self-concept from their affiliations with different social groups. These associations entail a strong emotional commitment with the goal of creating positive social identities that enhance our sense of self-worth. Social identity is a multifaceted construct, encompassing both public and private dimensions, and balancing

social and individual elements (Verkuyten, 2021), which implies that individuals not only perceive themselves through their group identities but also experience a sense of pride tied to the success or standing of their groups (Luhtanen & Crocker, 1992). There is a pivotal role of membership in groups in shaping self-esteem, as this study's results suggest that individuals, developing a strong sense of social identity may also experience an increase in their collective self-esteem (Marmarosh & Corazzini, 1997). The success or failure of one's group can resonate throughout both personal and collective self-perceptions. In line with Luhtanen and Crocker (1992) collective self-esteem is linked with the process of social identity formation and involves individuals' perceptions about the positivity of their own and others' views toward their group. This positive collective self-esteem, as highlighted by Cialdini et al. (1976), enables group members to bask in the achievements and status of their peers, fostering a sense of shared accomplishment and value. Wills (1981) noted that collective self-esteem is significantly influenced by intergroup comparisons, which can occur in either a downward or upward direction. Such comparisons allow individuals to work out the relative worth of their group compared to others, contributing further to the maintenance of collective self-esteem. These insights indicate the complex dynamics of group identity and collective self-esteem, highlighting their influence on individual perceptions, behaviors, and interactions within social contexts.

In terms of social networking sites, some aspects of social identity were associated with an increasing problematic Facebook use, specifically a growing sense of solidarity and attachment to fellow members of the in-group, as well as the prominence of one's group membership, were linked with a rise in problematic Facebook use as per Albery et al. (2021). As users become more deeply entrenched in online communities, their sense of self becomes increasingly dependent on their digital interactions, leading to experiences of withdrawal when access is restricted (Albery et al., 2021). Research suggests that social identity within

the Instagram community serves as an independent predictor of withdrawal symptoms in problematic IG use (Albery et al., 2024), which is why social identity as an SNS user shall be explored alongside how social media is used, as SNS serve as a medium for this identity to be established and modified accordingly. SNSs facilitate the social comparison process, as users constantly encounter curated positive images of other users' lives (Haferkamp & Krämer, 2011; Lim & Yang, 2015; Vogel et al., 2014). This study by Stapleton et al. (2017) focusing on Instagram, identified two factors that significantly influence self-esteem - seeking approval from others and engaging in social comparisons online. The content people choose to post, which is largely positive, helps them feel better about themselves in the group (Zhao et al., 2008; Yang et al. 2017). However, studies indicate that the content published on Instagram may be detrimental to mental health as such platforms can intensify the negative emotions brought on by social comparison processes, which can result in feelings of inadequacy or dissatisfaction (Stapleton et al. 2017; Appel et al. 2016). It was found that women with high connectedness in real life (offline) report higher level of social identity and higher social self-esteem levels (Lee & Robbins, 1998), as opposed to our digitalized era, Vogel et al. (2014) discovered that users with more activity on social media may experience diminished self-esteem and engage in unfavorable self-evaluations by comparing to other users.

This highlights the intricate relationship between online social identity, self-esteem, and comparison processes, especially among young adults navigating the digital realm. Instagram serves as a platform where users establish their in-group identity, engage in comparison processes, and potentially develop problematic usage patterns associated with signs of addiction, which will be further explored in detail below.

Problematic social media use and Self-esteem

Social media has transitioned from a pastime to an essential aspect of daily life for millions.

However, maladaptive social media use, characterized by signs of addiction and reduced self-

regulation, is associated with mental distress (Henzel & Håkansson, 2021). Compulsive social media use is also defined as problematic social media use (PSMU) or social media addiction (Sun & Zhang, 2021). There is a similarity between behavioral and chemical addictions and PSMU (Griffith, 2005; Young, 2015). PSMU manifests as an excessive preoccupation with social media, leading to impairment in various aspects like social interactions, relationships, work, and overall well-being (Andreassen & Pallesen, 2014; Bányai et al., 2017). Symptoms of PSMU encompass a range of addiction indicators, including heightened importance placed on social media (salience), withdrawal symptoms, and anxiety when social media use is restricted (Griffiths, 2005).

According to research, people who report pathological internet use, such as PSMU, typically have worse self-esteem and more social disinhibition (Niemz et al., 2005). Individuals with low self-efficacy and inadequate social skills may resort to substance abuse as a coping mechanism, as per Bandura's social learning theory (Bandura, 1997). When referred to our digital age, its manifestation can be seen in the compulsive use of social media as a coping method (Wisniewski et al., 2012). The findings might indicate that people abuse social media to either escape from low self-esteem or to increase it by getting "likes" and those with poor self-esteem could also favor online communication over in-person interactions (Martinez-Pecino & Garcia-Gavilan, 2019). However, it is impossible to determine the directionality because the data are cross-sectional, therefore problematic social media use might be a result and/or a predictor of poor self-esteem according to Andreassen et al. (2017).

Frequency of using Instagram and number of followers and following are associated with low self-esteem, depression and anxiety (Rozgonjuk et al., 2020; Malik & Khan, 2015; Sherlock & Wagstaff, 2018; Tazgini & Siedlecki, 2013). Additionally, Instagram usage has been linked to negative body image perceptions (Hendrickse et al., 2017; Kleemans et al., 2018) and the development of eating disorders (Teo & Collinson, 2018), both contributing to declining self-

esteem (Clay et al., 2005). Studies have shown that female Instagram users report increased envy, lowered self-esteem and life satisfaction (Cretti, 2015).

However results from research have been inconsistent as Mehdizadeh (2010) discovered that individuals with low self-worth engaged significantly more in self-promotional activities (such as sharing selfies) and paradoxically, others claim that active users were in fact those with higher self-esteem (Trifiro & Prena, 2021; Rahma & Setiasih, 2021). Considering this data, control predictors - which are general measures of social media activity- need to be defined. These include posting frequency, usage duration, weekly usage, and session duration.

Given the similarity between addictive behaviors and problematic social media use, it is necessary to describe some aspects of addictive patterns in order to comprehend this complexity. Cravings and desire thinking in relation to problematic IG use and its subsequent effects on self-esteem are still to be addressed.

Desire thinking and self-esteem

While social media addiction and others internet abuse, have not been formally recognized in the DSM-5, akin to other addictive behaviors, problematic social media use (PSMU) is defined by a central construct: craving (Leng et al., 2019; Turel & Bechara, 2016; Savci & Griffiths, 2021). By highlighting its significance as a core component of this phenomenon, studies reveal that cravings are fundamentally comparable for a variety of items, such as alcohol, drugs, cigarettes, gambling, and internet use (Castellani & Rugle, 1995; Field et al., 2008; Kavanagh et al., 2009).

People spending a lot of time on SM may be seen as seeking social connections as well as validation, comparison and escape, so to shift one's focus from an existing crave, one can

engage in controlled thought processes, or 'desire thinking', which is marked by a fixation on memories, mental imagery, and related data associated with the desired objective (Caselli & Spada, 2011). Paradoxically the more a person exerts desire thinking behavior the more the weight of the craving itself increases, as Garland and Roberts-Lewis' (2013) research demonstrates: increasing levels of thought suppression intensify craving. This two-way process of desire-thinking (DT) entails imaginal prefiguration (IP) and verbal perseveration (VP). Both components IP and VP were found to independently affect the problematic use of internet according to Spada et al. (2014). DT has been further associated with numerous of addictive disorders, problematic social media usage, increased problematic general social networking site use (Khosravani et al., 2022), Facebook use (Albery et al., 2021, Marino et al., 2019) internet use (Spada et al., 2014, Brandtner and Brand, 2021, Dragan and Grajewski, 2021).

Among people who use social media frequently, negative affect, impulsivity, and thought suppression are particularly prevalent (Efrati et al., 2021) and desire thinking serves as an underlying mechanism linking craving and PSMU to those established variables (impulsivity, negative affect, thought suppression) related to PSMU (Sharifi Bastan et al., 2022; Caselli & Spada, 2011). Desire thinking, alongside social identity predict problematic Instagram use according to most recent research (Albery et al., 2024).

There hasn't been any research delving into the relationship between desire thinking related to Instagram and self-esteem. As a result, the impact of these combined factors on self-esteem, both individually and collectively, remains unexplored territory. However, given the known association between desire-driven thinking and Problematic Social Media Use (PSMU), as well as its connection with various psychological aspects, it's reasonable to suggest that desire-driven thinking might indirectly influence self-esteem through its effect on PSMU.

Trait anxiety and Self-esteem

Trait anxiety refers to an inherent tendency to experience frequent worrying and become easily upset (Matthews & Odom, 1989). Individuals, reporting high levels of trait anxiety report being more vulnerable when being evaluated by others, as they tend to lack confidence and self-esteem (Spielberg & Rickman, 1990; Trimpey, 1989). A number of theories suggest that anxiety is mitigated by self-esteem (Crocker & Park, 2004). The impact of self-esteem on anxiety appears to be more pronounced, as suggested by Sowislo and Orth (2013), compared to the influence of anxiety on self-esteem (Manna et al., 2016; Doron et al. 2013; Guil et al., 2019), indicating there is a strong bi-variate relationship between anxiety and self-esteem (Li et al., 2023).

As discussed above PSMU is linked to range of addiction symptoms such as withdrawal and anxiety, if SM use is restricted (Griffiths, 2005). Prolonged anxiety can negatively affect confidence, resulting in lowered self-esteem and reinforcement of negative core beliefs according to the cognitive model (Fennell, 1997). Crocker and Park (2004) propose that experiences of anxiety shape the self-concept by continuously jeopardizing and diminishing self-esteem and highly anxious individuals might feel more threatened in social situations and be more sensitive to how others perceive them, leading to excessive mobile use to cope or escape from those uncomfortable feelings (You et al., 2019). From a social perspective, individuals with low levels of real-life connectedness struggle to properly manage their needs and emotions, and are more likely to experience anxiety and low self-esteem (Baker & Baker, 1987; Lee & Robbins, 1998). In social media context, anxious people,

considered sensitive to social status may compare to others and feel inferior, as suggested by Parsons et al. (2021) that higher levels of social anxiety were associated with a decrease in how individuals perceived their social rank and a decline in self-esteem while browsing on Instagram.

Another perspective is that the social media can potentially relieve some of the anxiety that people with low self-esteem often experience in traditional interpersonal situations, which could account for the combination of why people with lower self-esteem and higher anxiety levels report addictive social media use (Harman et al., 2005). Significant positive correlations have also been found between high levels of PSMU, anxiety and emotional investment in social media, and low self-esteem scores were associated with high involvement of feelings and PSMU (Woods & Scott, 2016).

Personal and Collective self-esteem

The term personal self-esteem describes a person's subjective assessments of their own value, respect, and confidence and how much they have positive or negative opinions about themselves (Sedikides & Gress, 2003). Collective self-esteem concerns the evaluation of one's worth and value as a member of a group or social category. It involves feelings of pride, belonging, identification with a particular group, community or society, and can be influenced by the perceived status, success, and reputation of the group to which one belongs (Luhtanen & Crocker, 1992). Positive correlations have been reported between individuals' levels of personal self-esteem and levels of group self-esteem, confirming a central tenet of social identity theory (Luhtanen & Crocker 1992; Crocker & Luhtanen, 1990).

Identity consolidation, which is a component of self-esteem, is greatly impacted by feedback from the social circles in which the individual exists (Erikson, 1986). These days, people use social networking sites (SNS) as a means of seeking external validation and reinforcement for

their self-concept by getting approval from others (Bazarova & Choi, 2014). According to research using SNS can play a pivotal role in shaping self-esteem for example by posting selfies, highlighting an idealized version of oneself to win the approval of others in order to receive likes (Konstam, 2015; Monago & Vaughn, 2015), which act as evidence to the close relations and social approval, central to one's self-worth (Tom & Hancock, 2013).

Existing research has linked problematic Instagram usage, Instagram in-group identity and desire thinking related to Instagram (Albery et al., 2024). However, there's a gap in the literature regarding how these factors alongside trait anxiety, collectively affect self-esteem on personal and collective levels. Therefore, it's crucial to investigate the complex link between these elements and self-esteem. The objective of this study is to present an exploratory overview of how thoughts about desires to use Instagram, Instagram social identity, trait anxiety and problematic Instagram use affect personal self-esteem and collective self-esteem, while accounting for relevant measures of general Instagram usage: length of using Instagram, weekly Instagram usage, frequency of posting and duration of a session Instagram use.

It is hypothesized that an Instagram user social identity, problematic Instagram use, Instagram related desire thinking and trait anxiety will significantly predict personal and collective self-esteem among adults, after controlling for their relevant indicators of general Instagram use: length, duration, posting frequency, weekly usage. Specifically, it is predicted that people, reporting lower levels of personal and collective self-esteem will report higher levels of problematic Instagram use, trait anxiety, desire thinking related to Instagram and Instagram user identification, even when controlling for relevant indicators of general Instagram use. Additionally, indicators of general Instagram usage are also expected to have a negative relationship with self-esteem.

Methods

Participants

Two hundred participants took part in the study, of which 69 identified as male and 131 identified as female. The mean age was 27.37 (SD=8.72). The inclusion criteria for this study were that participants were Instagram users and were aged over 18 years old. Participants were mostly single (53.5%), either in full-time (48%) or part-time jobs (8.5%) or students (35%). The majority were white (82.5%) and 51.5% stated their highest educational qualification obtained to be an undergraduate degree.

Almost half of the participants (46%) had been using Instagram for more than 5 years with 132 people (66%) reporting using it daily. About the duration of single use session 24.5% declare they are using Instagram for 1 hour per day, whilst 24% use it no more than 10 minutes daily. When asked about how often they post on Instagram 76 participants (38%) reported posting “sometimes”, “rarely posting” ($n = 72$, 36%), “often” posting ($n=36$, 18%) or “never posting” ($n=13$, 6.5%) and with only 3 (1.5%) reporting posting “always”. Age was shown to be significantly negatively associated with time as an Instagram user ($r=-.35$, $p < .001$), weekly Instagram use ($r=-.47$, $p < .001$), Duration use ($r=-.48$, $p < .001$) and posting behaviour ($r=-.35$, $p < .001$).

Materials

Demographics. Age, gender, marital status, and employment status were taken initially.

General Instagram use. Participants were asked about the length of being an IG user with answer options: “0 – 6 months”, “6 – 12 months”, “1 – 2 years”, “3 – 5 years” and “more than 5 years”. Then they were asked about the average daily usage with options: “0 – 10 minutes”, “10 – 20 minutes”, “half an hour”, “1 hour”, and “2+ hours”. About the average weekly use,

participants were given the following options to answer: “one day”, “two days”, “three days”, “four days”, “five days”, “six days”, and “seven days” and the last question was about the frequency of posting with answer scale ranging from never to always.

Desire Thinking Questionnaire (DTQ). To measure desire thinking related to Instagram the DTQ was adapted for Instagram (Castelli & Spada, 2011). It included ten statements spread over two categories - verbal perseveration (DTQ–VP, 5 items) – the persistence of thoughts regarding desire–related experiences (e.g., “If I did not use Instagram for a long time, I would think about it continuously”) – and imaginal prefiguration (DTQ–IP, 5 items) – the tendency to prefigure images about the desired experience (e.g., “I begin to imagine using Instagram every time it comes to my mind.”). Answers were given on four–point scales ranging from “Almost Never” to “Almost Always”. Higher scores on the total DTQ and on each of the subscales indicated high levels of related desire thinking (minimum score 10–maximum 40). DTQ–Total: $M = 15,51$, $SD = 5.26$, range 10 – 36; The DTQ–total had an excellent level of internal consistency ($\alpha = 0.92$). DTQ–IP: $M = 7.46$, $SD = 3.16$, range 5 – 19; The DTQ–IP–total had an appropriate level of internal consistency ($\alpha = 0.88$). DTQ–VP: $M = 8.05$, $SD = 2.86$, range 5 – 17. The DTQ–VP–total had an appropriate level of internal consistency ($\alpha = 0.86$). Items were presented in a random order to each of the participants.

State–Trait Anxiety Inventory (STAI–T5). The trait anxiety subscale of the STAI–T5 (Spielberger et al., 1971) was applied. Participants had to assess how they feel based on anxiety statement on a scale ranging from 1 (not at all) to 4 (very much so). The trait anxiety subscale (STAI–T5) consists of five statements with possible scores ranging from 5 to 20, respectively higher scores indicate greater anxiety. The STAI–T5 had a good level of internal consistency ($\alpha = 0.89$) ($M=9.31$; $SD=3.64$).

In-group identification. To measure social identification 14-item scale developed to operationalize self-definition (Cronbach's $\alpha = .87$) and self-investment dimensions ($\alpha = .88$) were used. Self-investment comprised three sub-scales; solidarity (Cronbach's $\alpha = .93$), satisfaction (Cronbach's $\alpha = .91$), and centrality (Cronbach's $\alpha = .95$). Self-identification was composed of two subscales, individual self-stereotyping (Cronbach's $\alpha = .93$) and in-group homogeneity (Cronbach's $\alpha = .95$). All statements were presented on seven-point scales (1 = "strongly disagree" to 7 = "strongly agree") with higher scores indicative of greater levels of component measures of identity (minimum score 7 and maximum score 35). Items were presented in random order for each of the participants.

The Rosenberg self-esteem scale. To measure personal self-esteem among subjects the 10-item scale of Rosenberg (1965) was utilized. Each participant was presented with a list of statements about their general feelings regarding their self-esteem and were asked to indicate how strongly they agree or disagree with each with possible answers ranging from "strongly agree" to "strongly disagree". Minimum score was 10, maximum score was 40, ($M = 32.20$; $SD = 5.13$). The scale had an appropriate level of internal consistency ($\alpha = 0.89$).

The Collective Self-esteem Scale . The CSE scale (Luhtanen and Crocker, 1992) was used to assess collective self-esteem. It consists of 16 items divided evenly into four subscales (membership esteem, public collective self-esteem, private collective self-esteem, and importance to identity). Responses were given on a 7-point Likert-type scale, which ranged from 1 (strongly disagree) to 7 (strongly agree) for each of the subscales. The Membership esteem subscale, which assesses the individualistic part of social identity ($M = 5.73$; $SD = 1.08$) had a good level of internal consistency (Cronbach's $\alpha = .81$). The Private CSE scale ($M = 5.75$;

SD=0.97) had a good level of internal consistency (Cronbach's $\alpha=.82$). The subscale measuring public SE (M=5.40; SD=0.91) had a good level of internal consistency ($\alpha=.74$). The subscale measuring importance to identity (M=5.21; SD=1.13) had a good level on internal consistency ($\alpha=.75$).

Social Media Use Questionnaire (SMUQ). To measure Problematic Instagram Use the SMUQ (Xanidis & Brignell, 2015) was adapted for Instagram use. The SMUQ-IU had nine items (Cronbach's $\alpha = .85$) across two subscales: Compulsion symptoms (four items, Cronbach's $\alpha = 0.9$; e.g., "I spend a large proportion of my day using Instagram.") (SMUQ-IU-Comp) and Withdrawal symptoms (five items, Cronbach's $\alpha = .88$; e.g., "I feel anxious when I am not able to check my Instagram account.") (SMUQ-IU-With). Participants responded by selecting how often they experienced each item on five-point scales, ranging from "Never" = 1 to "Always" = 5. Higher scores were indication of increased Problematic Instagram Use.

Design

For this research a cross-sectional correlational design has been used. The criterion variables are Personal self-esteem and Collective self-esteem and the four predictors are Problematic Instagram use, Instagram user identification, Desire thinking related to Instagram and Trait anxiety.

Procedure

Participants were recruited through the social media platforms Instagram and Facebook, on-campus advertising posters and using a Research Participation Scheme (RPS) at London South Bank University. The study was presented via the Gorilla platform (www.gorilla.sc). After giving their consent, participants completed demographic information (age, gender,

marital status, employment status, educational level), and indicators of daily and weekly Instagram use and frequency of posting. Participants then completed the Social Media Use Questionnaire for Instagram use (SMUQ-IU), the Desire Thinking Questionnaire (adapted for Instagram use) (DTQ), the in-group (Instagram users) self-identification measures, STAI-T5 for trait anxiety, the Collective Self-Esteem Questionnaire (CSE) and Rosenberg Personal Self-Esteem questionnaire. The sequence of these six instruments was varied among participants using a Latin square design for counterbalancing. The University Research Ethics Panel of London South Bank University approved the study.

Results

Initial Pearson's correlation coefficients between the personal self-esteem scale and all components of collective self-esteem and quantity/frequency measures of daily and weekly Instagram use (IG), frequency of posting, desire thinking related to IG, social identity as IG user, problematic IG use and trait anxiety were calculated to determine significant relationships for inclusion in subsequent regression analyses (see Table 1 and Table 2).

Bonferroni corrections for multiple tests were applied within each criterion variable such that only Pearson's r correlations achieving $p < .003$ were included as candidate predictors.

In terms of assumptions, a sample size of 200 was adequate given a maximum of 10 predictor variables included per regression. In addition, all of the Pearson r correlation coefficients between predictor variables were less than .80 ($-.03 < r < .65$).

Table 1: Bi-variate correlation matrix for the variables Personal self-esteem, Membership CSE, Private CSE, Public CSE, Importance of Identity CSE (level of statistical significance is indicated as * $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, * $p < .001$)**

	SMUQ -With	SMUQ -Comp	IDSoli d	IDSati s	IDCen t	IDSelSte r	IDHo m	DTQ_To t	DTQ_I P	DTQ_V P	STAI -T5
RosSE	-.112	-.326**	.221**	.271**	.194**	.121	.113	-.156*	-.207**	-.090	-.617**
CSEmem	.172*	-.263**	.472**	.501**	.454**	.378**	.394**	.046	-.018	.103	-.449**
CSEpriv	.170*	-.211**	.470**	.483**	.430**	.389**	.436**	.012	-.039	.059	-.435**
CSEpub	.138	-.106	.351**	.389**	.368**	.322**	.349**	.032	.005	.054	-.350**
CSEImpI D	.377**	-.152*	.551**	.559**	.598**	.542**	.541**	.211**	.126	.270**	-.300**

Table 2: Bi-variate correlation matrix for the variables Personal self-esteem, Membership CSE, Private CSE, Public CSE, Importance of Identity CSE (level of statistical significance is indicated as * $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, * $p < .001$)**

	Length	Duration	Weekly	Posting
RosSE	-.303**	-.271**	-.153*	-.067
CSEmem	-.412**	-.167*	.034	.131
CSEpriv	-.398**	-.138	.013	.095
CSEpub	-.275**	-.132	.002	.108
CSEImpID	-.412**	-.072	.087	.317**

Note: SMUQ-IU -social media use questionnaire; SMUQ-Comp – social media use questionnaire: compulsivity; SMUQ-With – social media use questionnaire: withdrawal; IDSolid – identity solidarity; IDSatis – identity satisfaction; IDCentr – identity centrality; IDselfSter – identity self-stereotyping; IDhom – identity in-group homogeneity; DTQ-Tot – desire thinking total; DTQ-VP – desire thinking verbal perseveration; DTQ-IP – desire thinking imaginal prefiguration; STAI-T5– trait anxiety; RosSE— personal self-esteem; CSEmemb– membership esteem; CSEimpID– importance of identity; CSEpublic– public esteem; CSEpriv– private self-esteem; Length-length of being a IG user; Duration- duration of single session IG use; Weekly – average weekly usage; Posting- frequency of posting.

Table 1 shows that personal self-esteem (RosSE) and compulsivity in problematic IG use (SMUQ-Comp), solidarity (IDsolid), satisfaction (IDsatis), centrality (IDcentr) measures of social identity, desire thinking (DTQ-tot), desire thinking- imaginal prefiguration (DTQ-IP) and trait anxiety (STAI-T5) have strong significant bi-variate relationships. Membership CSE and SMUQ-With, SMUQ-Comp, all Identity measures and STAI-T5 have a strong significant bi-variate relationship. Private CSE showed a strong significant two-way relationship with SMUQ-With and SMUQ-Comp, all Identity components and Trait anxiety. Public CSE has a strong significant dual relationship with all Identity measures and Trait anxiety. Importance of Identity in CSE and Withdrawal and Compulsivity in Problematic IG use, all Identity components, Total desire thinking, Desire Thinking-VP and Trait anxiety have a strong significant bi-variate relationship. Personal SE have a strong significant negative relationship with Trait Anxiety and Collective SE have a moderate to weak negative significant relationship with Trait Anxiety.

Descriptive statistics for all variables are reported in Table 3, which shows that for each variable the sample data contain a range of values and there is no evidence of floor or ceiling effects.

Table 3: Mean and Standard Deviations for the Desire thinking, Personal self-esteem, STAI-T5, Collective self-esteem, Social Identity components and Problematic Instagram use variables

	DTQ	DTQ	DTQ	RosS	STAI	CSE	CSEp	CSEp	CSEi	IDSati	IDSol	IDcen	IDsel	IDho	SMU	SMU
	Total	IP	–VP	E	T5	mem	riv	ublic	mpID	s	id	tr	fster	m	Q_Wi	Q_Co
															thdr	mp
Mean	15.5	7.46	8.05	32.2	9.31	5.73	5.75	5.40	5.21	4.88	4.74	3.94	4.77	4.98	2.01	2.23
SD	5.27	2.73	2.86	5.13	3.64	1.08	0.98	0.91	1.13	1.34	1.54	1.90	1.67	1.56	0.77	0.99
Min	10	5	5	19	5	2	3	3	2	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Max	31	17	17	40	20	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	4	5

*Please refer to *Note* under Table 2 for clarifications regarding the questionnaires.

After the identification of candidate predictors, analyses involved multiple linear regressions with Personal self-esteem and the four components of Collective self-esteem as criterion factors. The variables showing significant correlations with the criteria were deemed predictors in relevant models. In total of five hierarchical multiple linear regressions were undertaken separately for Rosenberg's personal self-esteem (Table 4) and the four subscales of Collective self-esteem: Collective Membership (Table 5), Private Self-esteem (Table 6), Public Self-esteem (Table 7), and Importance of Identity subscale (Table 8). Relevant indicators of general Instagram use (length of being an Instagram user, average weekly use, duration of Instagram session, frequency of posting) were entered in step 1 to enable the proportion of variance to be calculated for relevant measures of problematic Instagram use, desire thinking, STAI-T5 and social identity beyond that explained by Instagram usage measures.

Table 4: Model summary for a two stage Hierarchical Regression of Length, Duration, Weekly, SMUQ-Comp, IDsolid, IDSatis, IDcentr, DTQ-IP, DTQ-tot and STAI-T5 as predictors of Personal self-esteem

	R	R square	Model ANOVA	R square	Std.
	square	change	results	change	Error
				ANOVA	Est.
				results	
Block 1	.12	n/a	F (3,196) = 8.69,	n/a	4.85
(Length, Duration, Weekly)			$p < .001$		
Block 2					
(Length, Duration, Weekly, SMUQ–Comp, IDsolid, IDsatis, IDcentr, DTQ–Total, DTQ–IP, STAIT–T5)	.39	.27	F (10,189) = 11.99,	F	4.11
			$p < .001$	change(7,189) = 11.95,	
				$p < .001$	

*Please refer to *Note* under Table 2 for clarifications regarding the questionnaires.

Table 4 shows that for predicting personal self-esteem, at step 1 Length, Duration and Weekly Instagram usage were entered and shown to significantly predict the criterion $F(3,196)=8.69$, $p<.001$, $R^2=.12$, Adj. $R^2=.10$. Introducing SMUQ–Comp, IDsolid, IDsatis and IDcentr, DTQ–total, DTQ–IP and STAI–T5 into the equation at step 2 also resulted in significant regression

equation $F(10, 189)=11.99, p<.001, R^2=.39, \text{Adj. } R^2=.36$, accounting for additional 27% of the variance explained, $\Delta F(7, 188)=11.87, p<.001$.

Table 5: Coefficients for a two stage Hierarchical Regression of Length, Duration, Weekly, SMUQ-Comp, IDsolid, IDsatis, IDcentr, DTQ-IP, DTQ-tot and STAI-T5 as predictors of Personal self-esteem

	Unstanda rdized B	Unstandardized S.E.	t	p- value	Standardized Beta
Block 1					
Constant	38.31	1.81	21.16	<.001	
Length	-1.19	.38	-3.10	.002	-.23
Duration	-.74	.33	-2.2	.029	-.20
Weekly	.12	.29	.45	.655	.04
Block 2					
Constant	39.91	2.71	14.76	.000	
Length	-.14	.45	-.31	.760	-.03
Duration	-.33	.33	-1.01	.316	-.09
Weekly	.15	.25	.62	.537	.05
SMUQ-Comp	.43	.50	.86	.392	.09
IDsolid	-.09	.33	-.27	.790	-.03
IDsatis	.23	.42	.56	.578	.06
IDcentr	.03	.30	-.08	.934	-.01
DTQ-IP	-.18	.34	-.53	.594	.03
DTQ-Total	.03	.20	.14	.890	-.10
STAI-T5	-.83	.11	-7.77	<.001	-.59

*Please refer to *Note* under Table 2 for clarifications regarding the questionnaires.

In the final model in Block 2, STAI-T5 was the only significant independent predictor of personal self-esteem.

Table 6: Model summary for a two stage Hierarchical Regression of Length, Duration, SMUQ-With SMUQ-Comp, IDsolid, IDSatis, IDcentr, IDhom, IDselfstef and STAI-T5 as predictors of Membership in Collective Self-esteem

	R square	R square change	Model ANOVA results	R square change ANOVA results	Std. Error Est.
Block 1	.17	n/a	F (2,197) =	n/a	.98
(Length, Duration)			20.1, $p < .001$		
Block 2					
(Length Duration SMUQ-Comp, SMUQ-With, IDsolid, IDSatis, IDcentr, IDhom,	.34	.18	F (10,189) =9.91, $p < .001$	F change(8,189) =6.29 $p < .001$	.89

**IDselfster,
STAI-T5)**

*Please refer to *Note* under Table 2 for clarifications regarding the questionnaires.

The model predicting Membership in Collective self-esteem comprised at step 1 inclusion of Length and Duration. This resulted in a significant regression equation, $F(2,197)=20.1$, $p<.001$, $R^2=.17$. Introducing both components of SMUQ, IDsolid, IDcentr, IDselfster, IDhom, IDSatis, STAI-T5 at step 2 also resulted in a significant regression equation, $F(10,189)=9.91$, $p<.001$, $R^2=.34$, accounting for additional 18% of variance explained.

Table 7: Coefficients for a two stage Hierarchical Regression of Length, Duration, Weekly, SMUQ-With, SMUQ-Com, IDsolid, IDSatis, IDcentr, IDselfster, IDhom and STAI-T5 as predictors of Membership in Collective Self-esteem

	Unstandardized B	Unstandardized S.E.	t	p-value	Standardized Beta
Block 1					
Constant	7.5	.29	25.7	<.00	
Length	-.45	.08	-5.79	<.001.90	-.415
Duration	.01	.06	.12		.009
Block 2					
Constant	5.4	.59	9.12	.000	
Length	-.08	.10	-.84	.400	-.08

Duration	-.03	.07	-.37	.714	-.03
SMUQ-With	.04	.14	.30	.765	.03
SMUQ-Comp	.03	.11	.24	.813	.03
IDsolid	.10	.07	1.4	.180	.14
IDSatis	.17	.09	1.9	.066	.21
IDcent	.05	.07	.67	.507	.09
IDselfSter	-.07	.08	-.98	.329	-.11
IDhom	.04	.07	.52	.603	.06
STAI-T5	-.08	.02	-3.4	<.001	-.27

*Please refer to *Note* under Table 2 for clarifications regarding the questionnaires.

In the final model, STAI-T5 was the only significant negative independent predictor of Membership Collective self-esteem.

Table 8: Model summary for a two stage Hierarchical Regression of Length, SMUQ-With, SMUQ-Comp, IDsolid, IDSatis, IDcentr, IDhom, IDselfster and STAI-T5 as predictors of private collective self-esteem.

	R	R square	Model ANOVA	R square	Std.
	square	change	results	change	Error
				ANOVA	Est.
				results	
Block 1	.16	n/a	F (1,198) = 37.18,	n/a	.90
(Length)			$p < .001$		

Block 2

(Length,	.34	.18	F (9,190) =10.73,	F	.81
SMUQ-Comp,			$p < .001$	change(8,190)	
SMUQ-With,				= 6.41,	
IDSolid,				$p < .001$	
IDSatis,					
IDcentr,					
IDhom,					
IDselfster,					
STAI-T5)					

*Please refer to *Note* under Table 2 for clarifications regarding the questionnaires.

For predicting private collective self-esteem Length was entered at the first step and SMUQ–Comp, SMUQ–With, STAI–T5, all components of identity: IDhom IDSatis, IDSolid, IDselfster, IDcentr were added into the equation at step 2. A significant regression equation was shown at step 1, $F(1, 198)=37.18, p<.001, R^2=.16$, and with the addition of the other predictors at step 2, $F(9,190)=10.73, p<.001, R^2=.34$. The increase of 18% in variance explained between steps was also significant, $\Delta F (8, 190)= 6.41, p<.001$.

Table 9: Coefficients for a two stage Hierarchical Regression of Length, SMUQ-With, SMUQ-Comp, IDsolid, IDSatis, IDcentr, IDselfster, IDhom and STAI-T5 as predictors of Private Collective self-esteem

	Unstandardized B	Unstandardized S.E.	t	p- value	Standardized Beta
Block 1					
Constant	7.321	.266	27.551	<.001	
Length	-.389	.06	-6.097	<.001	-.40
Block 2					
Constant	5.34	.53	10.01	<.000	
Length	-.11	.09	-1.29	.217	-.11
SMUQ-With	-.04	.13	-.32	.749	-.03
SMUQ-Comp	.11	.09	1.15	.252	.11
IDsolid	.09	.07	1.39	.166	.15
IDSatis	.12	.08	1.51	.134	.17
IDcentr	.01	.07	.19	.850	.02
IDhom	-.07	.07	1.83	.068	.20
IDselfster	.12	.07	-1.00	.318	-.12
STAI-T5	-.07	.02	-3.51	.001	-.28

*Please refer to *Note* under Table 2 for clarifications regarding the questionnaires.

In the final Block STAI-T5 was the only significant negative independent predictor of Private Collective self-esteem, accounting for the additional 18% of variance explained in the criterion.

Table 10: Model summary for a two stage Hierarchical Regression of Length, IDsolid, IDsatis, IDcentr, IDhom, IDselfster and STAI-T5 as predictors of Public Collective Self-esteem

	R	R square	Model ANOVA	R square	Std.
	square	change	results	change	Error
				ANOVA	Est.
				results	
Block 1	.08	n/a	F (1,198) = 16.24,	n/a	.88
(Length)			$p < .001$		
Block 2	.21	.14	F (7,192) = 7.37,	F	.82
(Length			$p < .001$	change(6,192)	
IDsolid,				= 5.52,	
IDsatis,				$p < .001$	
IDcentr,					
IDhom,					
IDselfSter,					
STAI-T5)					

*Please refer to *Note* under Table 2 for clarifications regarding the questionnaires.

The model predicting public collective esteem comprised at step 1 inclusion of length of using Instagram. This resulted in a significant regression equation, $F(1,198) = 16.24, p < .001, R^2 = .08$. Introducing STAI-T5, identity components IDhom, IDsatis, IDsolid, self-stereotyping, centrality at step 2 also resulted in a significant regression equation $F(7,192) = 7.37, p < .001, R^2 = .21$, accounting for additional 14% of variance explained.

Table 11: Coefficients for a two stage Hierarchical Regression of Length, IDsolid, IDsatis, IDcentr, IDhom, IDselfster and STAI-T5 as predictors of Public Collective self-esteem

	Unstandardized B	Unstandardized S.E.	t	p– value	Standardized Beta
Block 1					
Constant	6.419	.260	24.72	<.001	
Length	–.252	.06	–4.03	<.001	–.28
Block 2					
Constant	4.72	.52	9.1	<.001	
Length	.05	.08	.60	.554	.054
IDsolid	.02	.07	.29	.774	.032
IDsatis	.09	.08	1.03	.306	.125
IDcentr	.07	.06	1.11	.268	.143
IDhom	–.02	.07	–.30	.762	–.038
IDselfSter	.07	.07	1.09	.279	.125
STAI-T5	–.06	.02	–3.09	.002	–.237

*Please refer to *Note* under Table 2 for clarifications regarding the questionnaires.

In the final model only STAI-T5 was found to be a significant independent predictor of public collective esteem accounting for 14% of the variance in predicting the criterion.

Table 12: Model summary for a two stage Hierarchical Regression of Length, Posting, SMUQ-With, SMUQ-Comp, IDsolid, IDSatis, IDcentr, IDhom, IDselfster, DTQ-Tot, DTQ-VP and STAI-T5 as predictors of Importance of Identity in Collective Self-Esteem.

	R	R square	Model ANOVA	R square	Std.
	square	change	results	change	Error
				ANOVA	Est.
				results	
Block 1	.29	n/a	F (2,197) = 39.23,	n/a	.96
(Length,			$p < .001$		
Posting)					
Block 2					
(Length,	.45	.16	F (12,199)	F	.86
Posting,			=12.63,	change(10,190)	
SMUQ-Comp,			$p < .001$	= 5.52,	
SMUQ-With,				$p < .001$	
IDsolid,					
IDSatis,					
IDcentr,					
IDhom					
IDselfster					
DTQ-Total					
DTQ-VP					
STAI-T5)					

*Please refer to *Note* under Table 2 for clarifications regarding the questionnaires.

For predicting importance of identity in CSE frequency of posting on Instagram and length of using Instagram were entered initially in the model. At step 2 SMUQ–Comp, SMUQ–With, all measures of identity: IDhom, IDSatis, IDsolid, self–stereotyping, IDcentr, STAI–T5, DTQ–VP, DTQ–Total were entered into the model. A significant regression equation was shown at step 1, $F(2, 197)=39.23, p<.001, R^2=.29$. With the addition of the other variables at step 2, this also resulted in a significant regression equation, $F(12, 199)=12.63, p<.001, R^2=.45$.

Table 13: Coefficients for a two stage Hierarchical Regression of Length, Posting, SMUQ–With, SMUQ–Comp, IDsolid, IDSatis, IDcentr, IDselfster, IDhom, DTQ–Total, DTQ–VP and STAI–T5 as predictors of Importance of Identity in Collective self–esteem

	Unstandardized B	Unstandardized S.E.	t	p–value	Standardized Beta
Block 1					
Constant	6.00	.35	17.38	<.001	
Length	–.49	.07	–7.13	<.001	–.43
Posting	.43	.08	5.62	<.001	.34
Block 2					
Constant	3.49	.57	6.10	<.001	
Length	–.06	.10	–.64	.526	–.05
Posting	.23	.09	2.52	.013	.18
SMUQ–With	.21	.16	1.34	.181	.14
SMUQ–Comp	.07	.10	.68	.496	.06
IDsolid	0.4	.07	.53	.598	.05
IDSatis	.08	.09	.82	.414	.09

IDcentr	.17	.07	2.45	.015	.29
IDselfster	.001	.07	.01	.994	.00
IDhom	.12	.07	1.67	.096	.17
DTQ–Total	–.03	.04	–.77	.440	–.15
DTQ–VP	–.03	.07	–.49	.640	–.09
STAI-T5	–.04	.02	–1.53	.127	–.11

*Please refer to *Note* under Table 2 for clarifications regarding the questionnaires.

In the final block frequency of posting on Instagram and centrality of identity were the only significant independent predictors of the criterion. Both significant predictors had a positive relationship with Importance of Identity, which could account for the additional 16% of variance explained.

Discussion

This study tested if in-group identification as an Instagram user, problematic Instagram use, desire thinking related to Instagram use and trait anxiety altogether predict personal self-esteem and collective self-esteem, while accounting for length of being an Instagram user, frequency of posting, duration of a session use and average Instagram usage per week. The results did partly support the model hypothesis, which stated that the combination of the predictors will negatively predict personal and collective self-esteem, even when general Instagram usage factors are held constant. There are several significant relationships resulting from the five hierarchical regressions conducted, which will be further discussed.

Trait anxiety emerged as the strongest significant independent predictor of personal self-esteem and of the three aspects of membership esteem, private collective esteem and public

esteem, which is widely supported by earlier work (Trimpey, 1989; Spielberg & Rickman, 1990; Manna et al., 2016; Doron et al., 2013; Guil et al., 2019). The hypothesis was partly supported, as the variance shared was not accounted for by all predictors: problematic IG use, Instagram user identity, desire thinking and trait anxiety. This may be explained by the strong bi-variate well established relationship existing between trait anxiety and self-esteem, as supported by past literature (Li et al., 2023). As the sole significant independent predictor of self-esteem, trait anxiety may negate the anticipated impacts of other predictors such as addictive Instagram use, social identity as an Instagram user, and desire thinking. Despite past literature indicating the influence of problematic social media and internet use on self-evaluations and self-esteem (Niemz et al., 2005; Rozgonjuk et al., 2020; Malik & Khan, 2015; Sherlock & Wagstaff, 2018; Tazgini & Siedlecki, 2013), these effects seem to be neutralized by anxiety in this study. To elucidate these outcomes, it's worth exploring whether anxiety serves as a mediating factor affecting self-esteem. A study by You et al. (2019) illustrated anxiety's mediating role in mobile phone use, suggesting a similar mechanism could be at play with Instagram usage and its impact on self-esteem in this case. For future replication of the study, it is considerate to investigate the mediating role of trait anxiety in the relationship between self-esteem and problematic Instagram use and investigate a larger sample preferably.

Two factors appeared to significantly predict the importance of identity in collective self-esteem, namely the frequency of posting on Instagram and the centrality of identity as an Instagram user. These factors were positively linked with the importance of identity measure, indicating that individuals who posted more frequently on Instagram and viewed their identity as an Instagram user as more integral to their overall sense of self (centrality) had higher levels of collective self-esteem, specifically the importance of their identity within the group, which is supported by past literature (Marmarosh & Corazzini, 1997; Lee & Robbins, 1998;

Verduyn et al, 2017). According to social identity theory importance of identity is directly relevant to the centrality of identity within a group the individual belongs (Luhtanen & Crocker, 1992). Collective self-esteem is a crucial part of shaping how individuals perceive and portray their group identity, and it influences their efforts to maintain a positive social image (Luhtanen & Crocker, 1990), indicating there is a two-way relationship between maintaining a collective self-esteem and positive social identity. The results align with the self-categorization theory, which proposes that the identification with a particular group leads to the group becoming a significant component of an one's self perception (Turner & Reynolds, 2012), suggesting that when the identity as an Instagram user is central to the sense of self, users tend to report higher levels of collective self-esteem. These findings also correspond with this study's results, where centrality was linked to the subjective importance individuals placed on their membership in a specific group (Leach et al., 2008).

The frequency of posting on Instagram as a significant predictor of the importance of identity in collective self-esteem is supported by past research, demonstrating a significant positive correlation between frequent use of Instagram and users' self-esteem levels, with the intensity of Instagram use acting as a mediator in this relationship (Trifiro & Prena, 2021; Rahma & Setiasih, 2021). Active engagement on social media platforms, such as posting and interacting, has been shown to positively impact well-being by fostering support and positive feedback, crucial for maintaining group self-esteem. In contrast, passive social media consumption tends to trigger social comparison and feelings of envy (Verduyn et al., 2015; 2017). However, there is mixed evidence in the literature, as some studies suggest that individuals with lower self-esteem engage more frequently in self-promotional behaviors on platforms like Facebook, indicating a negative relationship between these variables (Mehdizadeh, 2010). It's worth noting that previous research has primarily focused on Facebook, and while both platforms share similarities, there are differences in user behavior

and content types they share, with Facebook emphasizing text-rich posts and status updates while Instagram posting is predominantly image-orientated like selfies (Sheldon et al, 2011; Jun, 2022).

This study highlights how often someone posts on Instagram and their sense of identity as an Instagram user affect their collective self-esteem, especially how important they feel in the Instagram community. It also shows that feeling anxious by nature strongly predicts lower personal and some aspects of collective self-esteem, which aligns with existing research.

While the study's hypothesis wasn't fully supported by the regression results, anxiety emerged as the strongest independent negative predictor of self-esteem on both personal and collective levels which is consistent with prior research findings. Social identity was observed to positively predict collective self-esteem, aligning with social identity theory (Luhtanen & Crocker, 1992). However more investigation into the impact of social media is necessary, particularly how virtual environments and communication methods shape in-group identity, the role of Instagram addiction in forming an addict identity, and how group membership within Instagram communities affects users' sense of belonging and support. Additionally, exploring the biological aspect, such as the dopamine response to Instagram use, and understanding its implications for individuals' self-esteem and well-being requires further in-depth research, especially given the expanding influence of Instagram.

One of the study's drawbacks is its reliance on self-assessment. However it compensates for this by having a considerable sample size of 200 which is difficult to be achieved without self-report questionnaires. Nonetheless, relying on such may allow participants to consciously influence their responses, potentially leading to inaccuracies in the data (Hofstee, 1994).

Concerning the self-report questionnaires for social identity, problematic social media use and

trait anxiety other kinds of assessment such as a structured interview or observation of use might provide a more valid evaluation and therefore different results.

In conclusion, this study clarifies certain aspects that may help us recognize the ways in which social media usage affects self-esteem. When assessing collective self-esteem, the importance of one's identity as an Instagram member and the frequency of posting on the platform seem to be important aspects. Across several study samples, there was a consistent correlation between these characteristics and the individuals' overall self-esteem levels.

Nonetheless, more studies focusing on various demographics, cultures, etc., are necessary to investigate the relationships among problematic Instagram use, social identity, desire thinking, trait anxiety, and self-esteem.

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13/05/2024

Reference: Psychology Graduate

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Psychology Graduate position at a secondary school in Lambeth as advertised on Ribbons & Reeves, please find my CV attached. I am looking for a full-time position to apply my knowledge in a school environment, whilst gaining experience in helping children in their studies.

With a passion for helping others and extensive experience in supporting those in need, I've committed myself to volunteering with individuals requiring care and support. Whether advocating for children in foster care or assisting those with severe medical conditions, my dedication to creating positive change is unwavering. In my role, I've spearheaded impactful initiatives aimed at improving the lives of vulnerable children, organizing charity events to raise crucial funds for their treatment. I have been volunteering with the People To People International for more than 2 years and became the vice-president of the chapter in my home town. I assumed full responsibility for planning and executing fundraising endeavors, while working with other volunteers and visiting children in foster care. Through compelling verbal presentations, I've effectively raised awareness about our organization's mission and objectives, captivating volunteers along the way. Through my strategic leadership and dedicated efforts, I've not only upheld the values of PTPI but also made a tangible difference in the lives of children in need. I truly understand the value of giving back to the local community and the personal development made possible by community outreach

As London's premier Education Recruiters, Ribbons & Reeves provides an opportunity for recent graduates to gain hands-on experience in educational settings, fostering the development of their professional skills. I am eager to transition into a new role with Ribbons & Reeves, leveraging this unique opportunity to further cultivate my researching skills and expertise. As a recent Psychology Graduate my final year empirical project required a full dedication in conducting a piece of research, which shaped my ability to communicate complex ideas effectively, as this skill is crucial in an educational environment where clear communication is key to facilitating learning and understanding. My study focused on the detrimental effects social media platforms such as Instagram can have on self-esteem, which is a crucial aspect of the further development and well-being of young adults, who are the main users of Instagram. While conducting my empirical research I was equipped with essential skills like time management, critical thinking, and prioritization. These skills are highly transferable and relevant in the field of education, where managing diverse tasks and addressing complex issues are common. My background in psychology, particularly my research on the impact of social media on self-esteem among young adults, could be an asset in an educational setting.

Thank you for taking the time to review my application and please do get in contact if you require any further information. I am available for virtual and in person interviews across May and June.

Yours sincerely,

Kristina Divrova

Kristina Divrova ©

BSc Clinical Psychology